Amelia (Mila) Ardath

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Software engineer working on observability tooling. Maintainer of otel-desktop-viewer, an open-source local OpenTelemetry viewer — OTLP ingestion, embedded storage, and the frontend to make telemetry legible. Go, TypeScript, SQL, and a strong opinion about developer tools that work offline.

Skills

Go, TypeScript, SQL, DuckDB, PostgreSQL, schema design, Svelte, OpenTelemetry, OTLP, distributed tracing, observability, Kubernetes, Docker, GitHub Actions

Experience

Open Source Maintainer, otel-desktop-viewer — 2023–present

github.com/CtrlSpice/otel-desktop-viewer

A local OpenTelemetry viewer: receives OTLP over HTTP and gRPC and renders traces, metrics, and logs in a browser, with no external observability platform required.

- Architected it as a custom OpenTelemetry Collector distribution: an exporter that writes telemetry, and a collector extension that owns the DuckDB store and the web UI, so storage outlives the pipeline
- Designed the analytical schema for traces, metrics, and logs, including a content-addressed attribute dictionary that dedupes attributes at ingest
- Implemented metric reduction and OTLP exponential-histogram merging in SQL, where a wrong answer still renders as a plausible chart — found four such bugs, and now verify the results against an independent implementation over randomized inputs
- Built the Svelte 5 frontend, including a search language with a Lezer grammar in CodeMirror that the Go backend compiles into SQL
- Built the release pipeline: a GitHub Actions matrix on native runners per platform (CGO rules out cross-compilation), publishing to Homebrew, GHCR, deb/rpm, and GitHub Releases across macOS, Linux, and Windows

Senior Software Engineer, Telus — 2023–2025

Internal platform organization; deployment automation for services running on Kubernetes.

- Designed and implemented the tick-based state machine at the core of a tool automating blue-green and canary deployments
- Built a golden-signal metrics comparator used as a deploy gate, so only artifacts with stable metrics promote to production
- Authored an OpenTelemetry adoption RFC and presented it to the Architecture Guild
- Technologies: Go, Kubernetes, client-go, PostgreSQL

Career break — 2016–2022

Firmware Testing and Integration Developer, Ciena — 2014–2016

- White-box firmware testing on fiber-optic network equipment, network simulation tooling to reproduce configuration errors, and thermal cycling in environmental chambers to see how switches would do in a desert
- Technologies: C, C++, TCL, Perl, Bash

Developer, Applied Research and Innovation, Algonquin College — 2012–2014

- Prototyped pro-athlete vision-training drills as a Unity game with an optometrist client, to see how they could be made accessible to more people; designed a backend-as-a-service for rapid prototyping
- Technologies: C#, Unity, Java, Android, MySQL

Education

Recurse Center, New York — 2025–2026

Self-directed programming retreat, admitted by application. Completed a 12-week batch and a 6-week batch.

Advanced Diploma, Engineering Technology and Computer Science, Algonquin College — 2014